5.4.7 Pre - disposing factor for decubitus ulcer

1) ***Unconscious, helpless or acutely ill patients:*** These patients are unable to appreciate the weight of pressure and change their position.
2) ***Paralysed patients (Paraplegic and quadriplegic patients):*** They have lost motor and sensory functions of the limbs.
3) ***Patients with incontinence. (Spinal injuries)***: Void on the bed as the urinary sphincters loses its control.
4) Aged persons.
5) Very emaciated and malnourished people.
6) Patients with dehydration or oedema.
7) Very fat people.
8) Patients with disease affecting circulation. eg. Heart diseases and anaemia.
9) Patients with debilitating diseases such as cancer and tuberculosis.
10) Patients with metabolic disorders. eg. Diabetes.

5.4.7.1. Causes, condition and prevention of decubitis ulcer

Causes	*Conditions*	*Prevention*
(a) ***Pressure:*** When any body prominence presses upon the bed, the tissues lying between them get reduced blood supply. If this condition prolongs, the superficial tissue necroses, skin breaks down and formation of an ulcer takes place.	***The following condition causes prolonged pressure:*** 1) Leaving a patient in one position for a long time. 2) Leaving a patient on a bedpan for a long while. 3) Hard and lumpy mattress. 4) Pressure exerted by splints and plaster casts.	1) Establish a turning schedule for bedridden patients; turn every second hourly. 2) Have a firm cot and foam mattress for bed-ridden patientsuse extra pillows, pads and air rings to reduce pressure.
(***b) Friction:*** 1) Friction from bedclothes or any other cause irritates the skin leading to inflammation. 2) If you lie on a bed sheet, which has a rough seam in the middle of it for a while, you will notice the impression of the seam on your back. 3) You will also experience burning sensation and the part will be red colour.	***The following factors which cause friction in a patient:*** 1) Careless pulling of patient and his linen. 2) Giving and removing bed pan carelessly. 3) Leaving broad crumbs, orange seeds and food particles on the bed. 4) Creases in the bottom sheet. 5) General restlessness of patient. 6) Rubbing two skin surfaces together.	1) When changing position of your patient lift him and do not drag him on to the bed. 2) Keep sheets without wrinkles and seams. 3) Keep bed clean and free from crumbs. 4) If patient is restless, protect pressure points with soft pads.

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